

Snowden's skills impressed his supervisors at CIA headquarters, allowing him to move up within the agency quickly.

Seeds of Discontent

While working for the CIA in Geneva, Snowden was disheartened by the ways CIA agents recruited foreigners with hope for receiving valuable information for the agency. For example, Snowden asserted one agent got a prospective recruit drunk, urged him or her to drive home, and then offered to help after he or she was arrested for drunk driving. In addition, Snowden's job maintaining CIA computer systems gave him access to information about the Iraq War. He was unnerved by the details of torture and warrantless wiretapping he discovered. "The war on terror had gotten really dark," he told an interviewer about that period of history.[3]

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Edward Snowden: NSA Whistle-Blower, ABDO Publishing Company, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,